❖ Industrial Waste

The discharge of untreated industrial wastes from the industries into rivers and lakes is one of the main causes of water pollution. The industrial wastes contain harmful substances such as acid, alkalis and hot water. The chemicals like Arsenic, Lead, Mercury and Cadmium are released by the industries and it leads to toxicity in plants and animals.



❖ Sewage

The dumping of sewage into rivers and lakes is the second major cause of water pollution in big cities.



❖ Domestic Waste

Food waste, soaps and detergents, garbage, wrappers, plastics and other materials carried by the flowing water pollute the water bodies.

❖ Chemical Fertilizers and Insecticides

The excess use of fertilizers and pesticides causes water pollution. Because these chemicals are washed into the rivers and lakes with rainwater, they pollute the soil and underground water also. Pesticides like DDT (Dichloro Diphenyl Trichloroethane) enter the bodies of aquatic animals and reach the human body by way of food chain.



❖ Synthetic Detergents

Excess use of synthetic detergents for washing purposes produces foam and they pollute the water.

❖ Oil Spill

Oil leakages on the surface of the sea affect the marine organisms.



2 Prevention of Water Pollution

- Excess use of fertilizers and pesticides should be avoided in agricultural land.
- Use of synthetic detergents should be minimized or biodegradable detergents should be used.
- Trees and shrubs should be planted along the banks of the rivers or lakes.

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